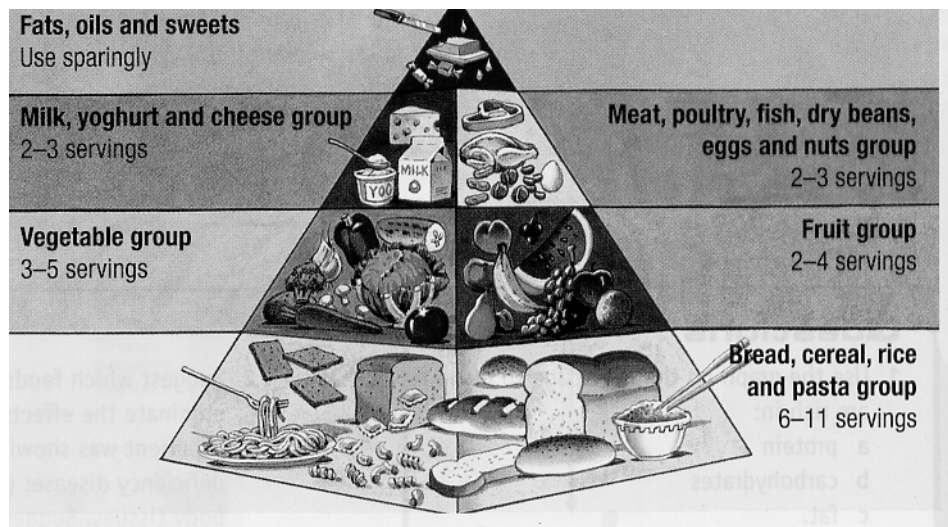


DIET AND HEALTH

A food pyramid shows the types and amounts of food that should be eaten for a balanced diet.



The main food groups are as follows.

Carbohydrates

- Main role is to provide energy.
- Food groups are bread, cereals, fruits, honey, starch.
- Related disease: diabetes.

Proteins

- Needed for growth and repair.
- Food groups are meats, dairy, nuts, eggs, cereals, vegetables.
- Contain sugars and starch that break down to glucose during digestion.
- Related disease: kwashiorkor.

Fats and Oils

- Also called ***lipids***.
- Produce twice the energy of carbohydrates.
- Stored by the body as an energy reserve.
- Food groups are butter and animal fat; oils such as olive, canola and vegetable.
- Related diseases: arteriosclerosis (blockage of arteries), heart disease.

Vitamins and Minerals

- Found in small quantities in foods.
- Used in various cell reactions; for healthy bones, muscles and nerves.
- Food groups are meats, dairy, fruits, vegetables.
- Related diseases: beriberi, scurvy, rickets.

There are two essential non-nutrients for the body.

Water

- Makes up two-thirds of the body.
- Needed for many of the chemical reactions in the body.
- Lose an average of 2.0 L per day through urinating and breathing.
- Can die within 3 days with no water.

Fibre

- Comes from plant cells.
- Makes food move smoothly through the digestive system.
- Foods include grains and wholegrain products.
- Related diseases: constipation, bowel cancer, haemorrhoids.